standby databases are launched into two different availability zones. AWS calls the high-availability deployment of RDS Multi-AZ deployment for this reason.

In addition to the fact that a high-availability deployment increases your database's reliability, it offers another important advantage: reconfiguring or maintaining a single-mode database causes short downtimes. High-availability deployment of an RDS database solves this problem because AWS switches to the standby database during maintenance.

10.6 Tweaking database performance

When search engines decide in which order to present the search results, the loading speed of a website is an important factor. Therefore, it is important to optimize the performance of your WordPress site. You will learn how to make sure the MySQL database is not slowing down your website in this section.

The easiest way to scale a RDS database, or an SQL database in general, is to scale *vertically*. Scaling a database vertically means increasing the following resources of your database instance:

- Faster CPU
- More memory
- Faster storage

Keep in mind that you can't scale vertically (which means increasing resources) without limits. One of the largest RDS database instance types comes with 32 cores and 244 GiB memory. In comparison, an object store like S3 or a NoSQL database like DynamoDB can be